

A CAPABILITY FORMATION EXPERIENCE

Stay or Leave?

Live Career Growth Assessment

Read the Position Before You Make the Move

FREE GUIDED ASSESSMENT · 60 MINUTES

WELCOME

Why I Built This Lesson

My career has moved through accounting and audit, cybersecurity, people strategy, employee experience and enterprise transformation, across multiple industries and sectors.

That journey made me interested in a different career question:

In 2026, the question became personal.

“Can a career begin to stall while the person is still performing well?”



Temidayo Afonja

The question underneath the question

WHAT YOU CAME IN ASKING

**“Should I stay in this role,
or should I go?”**

WHAT YOU NEED TO ANSWER FIRST

**“Is this work still building
me, and what would still
travel if the context
changed?”**

The first question is yours alone. The second sits upstream of it, and this session can read it more rigorously.

The session, today will and will not...

This read will not tell you to stay or leave.

IT WILL

Give you a defensible reading of your current position, and **all seven categories of move**, then the one your evidence supports testing.

IT WILL NOT

Predict layoffs, diagnose your employer, or make an employment decision for you.

YOUR SCORES

Stay private. Nothing is submitted, collected or shared at any point.

THE RECORDING

The teaching runs to minute 50 and is recorded. The last ten minutes are live questions and are not recorded.

This is not legal, medical, financial, immigration or mental-health advice.

Definitions

DEFINITION ONE

Is the work still building you?

This reading calls that Density.

DENSITY reads whether this environment is still forming you. It reads your conditions, not your effort. A role can be demanding, important and exhausting and still stop building you.

Not how busy you are. Not how much pressure you carry. Not how much the organization depends on you. The question is whether the work is still asking more of your judgment than it did ninety days ago.

Six statements measure it. You will score them in a moment.

Will what you build still travel?

Optionality reads whether what this work is building stays useful beyond your current context, and whether you could make it legible to someone outside your organization using evidence rather than your title.

A low score is not a verdict on your ability. And translation is not recognition. Making your work legible removes a barrier. It does not decide what another organization does with what it sees.

Six statements measure it. Same scale, same window.

Your initial read: statements 1 to 3

Density. Live, silent. 1 strongly disagree to 5 strongly agree.

1 In the last ninety days I have been handed a problem I did not already know how to solve.

1 2 3 4 5

2 I work close enough to people who are better than me that I can watch how they think.

1 2 3 4 5

3 My work is reviewed by someone who can tell the difference between good and adequate, and who says so directly.

1 2 3 4 5

Your initial read: statements 4 to 6

Density, continued. Same window, same instruction.

4

The feedback I receive changes what I do next, not just how I feel.

1 2 3 4 5

5

I regularly operate at the edge of my competence rather than the comfortable center of it.

1 2 3 4 5

6

Looking back six months, the work I do now would have been genuinely hard for me then.

1 2 3 4 5

INITIAL READ

Your initial Density reading

Add statements 1 to 6.

INITIAL DENSITY TOTAL

_____ / 30

19 to 30 is high

6 to 18 is low

17 to 21 is the boundary band

Hold the number. Do not share it.

A total inside 17 to 21 sits on the boundary. It does not resolve to high or low — you will read both neighbouring states rather than pick one.

Your initial read: statements 7 to 9

Optionality. Same scale, same window.

7 The capability I am building would be valued by an employer in a different industry.

1 2 3 4 5

8 I can describe what I do in terms of outcomes, not just my company's internal language.

1 2 3 4 5

9 If my role disappeared tomorrow, the capability I built would still be mine to carry.

1 2 3 4 5

Your initial read: statements 10 to 12

Optionality, continued. Last block of the first pass.

- | | | | | | | |
|-----------|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| 10 | People with the power to hire or advance me, inside or outside my company, can already see what I am good at. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| 11 | What I am learning is a transferable capability rather than a company-specific procedure. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |
| 12 | I could rebuild a strong position somewhere else within a year. | 1 | 2 | 3 | 4 | 5 |

INITIAL READ

Your initial Optionality reading

Add statements 7 to 12.

INITIAL OPTIONALITY TOTAL

_____ / 30

19 to 30 is high

6 to 18 is low

17 to 21 is the boundary
band

Hold the number. Do not share it.

A total inside 17 to 21 sits on the boundary. It does not resolve to high or low, you will read both neighbouring states rather than pick one.

Matrix

The four states

Density crossed with Optionality. Your state helps you see a form of exposure your job title cannot.

DENSITY / HIGH

2 DEPTH TRAP

Deep expertise fused to one context.

4 COMPOUNDING

Deep capability that travels.

DENSITY / LOW

1 STAGNANT

The work stopped asking more of you.
Neither axis is moving.

3 FRAGILE

Options on paper, not enough depth
beneath.
What you built travels. It is just not being
added to.

OPTIONALITY: LOW AT LEFT → HIGH AT RIGHT

FIRST PLACEMENT

Place yourself. Privately, and provisionally.

Cross your two numbers, then rate your confidence in the placement from 1 to 5.

1 Cross Density and Optionality

Two totals, one square. If either total sits inside 17 to 21, mark it boundary instead of picking a square.

2 Rate your confidence from 1 to 5

Write the number privately. You will compare it against your confidence after the evidence pass.

3 Hold it lightly

This is a first read, not a finding. State is not identity; it reads conditions in a ninety-day window, and it moves.

The evidence protocol

This is what your second reading has to survive.

Every corrected score requires an evidence line from the last ninety days. Every score, in both directions.

A 4 OR 5

At least one clear positive instance from within the window.

A 3

The mixed or inconsistent pattern. A 3 is a reading, not an absence of one.

A 1 OR 2

What repeatedly happened instead, a counterexample, or no qualifying instance in the window.

A ?

Cannot support it either way? Write your most defensible number and add one question mark: 3?, 4?, 2?

A 3 means mixed. A question mark means unsupported.

Three ways a self-score goes wrong

Run all three against your first numbers before you rescore.

1. SCORING THE INTENDED LIFE

"My rotation was approved last month. Statement 1 gets a 4."

The window is the last ninety days of work that happened — not work that was approved, promised or planned.

2. CONFUSING VALUED WITH FORMED

"Three VPs ask for my read before anything ships. Statement 3 gets a 5."

Being relied on is real. It is not the same as being developed.

3. READING LOW OPTIONALITY AS A VERDICT

"Statement 10 is a 2 because I am not senior enough."

A low Optionality score may reflect context-bound capability, weak translation, limited exposure, or a combination. It is not a verdict on ability or worth.

Three is the set. Run them, then rescore.

Score all twelve again

Evidence in both directions. Do not change your first number.

THE PROTOCOL, IN SHORT

4 or 5	one clear positive instance	3	the mixed or inconsistent pattern
1 or 2	what happened instead, or no qualifying instance	?	most defensible number, marked once: 3?, 4?, 2?

Density 1 · 2 · 3 · 4 · 5 · 6

Optionality 7 · 8 · 9 · 10 · 11 · 12

Write the corrected number and a short evidence phrase under it. Your first number stays where it is.
Phrases, not essays — twelve minutes for twelve statements.

Workbook pages 5 and 6.

Re-total before you place again

New numbers. A fresh placement, not a review of the first one.

DENSITY, CORRECTED

_____ / 30

OPTIONALITY, CORRECTED

_____ / 30

19 to 30 high · 6 to 18 low · 17 to 21 is the boundary band, and it overrides both

Total the axis using the numbers exactly as you wrote them. A question-marked score counts as its number.

Rate your confidence in the corrected placement from 1 to 5.

When the evidence remains uncertain

The sensitivity check. An operational convention, not a statistical confidence interval.

NONE

Use the corrected total normally.

No sensitivity range is required.

1 OR 2

PROVISIONAL. RUN THE NEIGHBORING-SCORE SENSITIVITY CHECK.

- If the range touches 17 to 21, hold the axis as boundary.

3+

INCOMPLETE. Do not place on that axis today. Incomplete is a legitimate reading, not a failure.

17 TO 21 IS THE BOUNDARY BAND. A boundary reading overrides the normal high and low split.

ONE axis in the band: read the two adjacent states the other axis selects.

BOTH axes in the band: record Boundary and assign no single state.

Your corrected position

1 Place your corrected square

Or mark boundary, or mark the axis incomplete. All three are legitimate readings.

2 Rate your confidence from 1 to 5

Compare it with the confidence number from your first placement on workbook page 3. The comparison is private.

3 Keep both readings visible

The first number and the corrected number sit side by side. The distance between them is the finding.

A position you can defend with evidence is worth more than a position you feel confident about.

What moved when you tested your first read

After testing your first read against evidence, which is closest?

- My totals moved meaningfully
- My provisional position moved
- My position stayed similar, but I trust the reading more
- My evidence is still incomplete

Every one of these is a legitimate outcome. Incomplete evidence is information, not failure.

What each state costs

Four states. One immediate cost to notice in each.

STAGNANT

Neither axis is accruing.

DEPTH TRAP

Value is deep but context-bound.

FRAGILE

What travels today is no longer being renewed.

COMPOUNDING

A strong current position still requires renewal.

That is the reading this assessment gives you today, and it is complete. Working a square in depth, against a named destination, and rerunning it as conditions change is what continued work adds.

Signals Worth Watching

Questions to investigate, not predictions.

Your reading describes the last ninety days. These signals tell you what to watch between now and your next read.

Signals around your role

- 1 Your mandate is being absorbed, narrowed, duplicated, or redefined again.
- 2 Decisions about your work are being made in rooms you are no longer in.
- 3 Your role exists because of one sponsor, and that sponsor's position is changing.
- 4 Few people outside your manager would notice if your function disappeared.
- 5 The routine parts of your work are getting easier to automate or reproduce.

One signal is something to examine. Several together are worth testing a move.

Signals when things feel fine

Compounding is the state most likely to feel fine. A strong position still needs renewal.

- 1 You cannot name what you are learning right now.
- 2 You are being praised for the same things as last year.
- 3 Your last unfamiliar problem was more than 90 days ago.
- 4 Your evidence has not been updated in a quarter.
- 5 People outside your organization have not seen your recent work.

Choose two signals to watch before your rescore date.

Seven categories of move

Direction, not a plan. Your evidence helps you choose which category to test.

- | | | |
|---|-------------------------------------|---|
| 1 | Remain and deepen | The formation conditions are real and worth protecting. |
| 2 | Translate what is built | The capability exists. The evidence for it is not yet legible outside. |
| 3 | Widen exposure | Reach people who can evaluate or use it. Visibility is not evidence. |
| 4 | Test portability | Find out what travels before you need it to. |
| 5 | Repair formation conditions | Test whether changing the work or conditions could repair the problem. |
| 6 | Prepare for exit | Your evidence gives you reason to prepare in case the conditions do not repair. |
| 7 | Seek an external perspective | High stakes, incomplete evidence, or a boundary position. |

No square prescribes a category. Your evidence and constraints still apply.

The Next-Move Note

Three lines. Yours, private, and enough to act on.

What travels?

What does not?

What can I prove?

What must I relearn?

MY CURRENT READ

My position appears to be:

State / boundary / incomplete

WHAT I NEED TO TEST

The category of move my evidence supports testing is:

One of the seven categories.

WHAT HAPPENS NEXT

The next action, conversation or piece of evidence is:

One thing. Something you could begin this month.

Two signals I will watch before my rescore date: _____ and _____

This is a note, not a decision. It records what your evidence supports testing next.

Choose How You Want to Continue the Read

Your read is complete. What you need next depends on what is still unresolved.

1

I have enough for now.

Take your Next-Move Note and act on it.

Nothing further is required. The session was built to be complete on its own.

2

I want to keep working privately.

Continue with the Capability Formation Field Kit.

You understand your reading and want a structured system you can return to on your own.

Different unresolved needs require different levels of support.

This session gives you a guided reading. The Field Kit gives you a system you can return to.

TODAY'S GUIDED READ

- An initial and evidence-based reading
- A provisional position
- One move category to test
- A written Next-Move Note

Complete on its own.

CAPABILITY FORMATION FIELD KIT

- Fuller state-cost work
- A repeatable private evidence process
- Structured rescoring as conditions change
- A system you own and return to

EXPLORE THE FIELD KIT

temidayoafonja.com/fieldkit



Use the Field Kit when you want to keep reading the position without needing another live session.

BEFORE YOU GO

You came in asking stay or leave. You leave with a clearer read.

I have not made that decision for you, and I should not. What you have is a clearer read of what this work is building, what may travel, where the evidence is thin, and what deserves testing next. Put a date ninety days from now on your note, then come back and see what changed.

Q & A